

IBM Expertise Connect

Immediate access to deep technical expertise



2026 IBM Expertise Connect Comes to You Seminar

Welcome!



October 6th & 7th 2026

Where:

2300 Dulles Station West Blvd, Herndon, VA 20171

Time:

8:00 AM USA EDT to 5:00 PM USA EDT

Ayron Fears (WebSphere - Technical Account Manager)
Tiffanie Watkins (WebSphere MQ - Technical Account Manager)
Michelle Mashia Cross Brand - Sr. Technical Account Manager
Jennifer Noble (Cross Brand - Sr. Technical Account Manager)
John Alex (Expertise Connect Delivery Manager - Practice Manager)

Agenda (Tuesday, October 6th, 2026)

****All sessions given under NDA****

Time	Topic	Presenter
8:00 AM – 8:30 AM EDT	Welcome, Breakfast & Introduction	Jennifer Noble, Tiffanie Watkins, John Alex, Michelle Mashia
8:30 AM – 9:00 AM EDT	<u>Panel Discussion:</u> Where Are You Now? ➤ Review of current architecture and strategic direction	Panel: Varun Jain, Ulas Cubuk, Yana Johnson, Ulas Cubuk, Kieran Murphy, Tamika Moody, Tiffanie Watkins
09:00 AM – 10:00 AM EDT	What's New in ACE ➤ Latest updates and features in IBM App Connect Enterprise ➤ Demo	Varun Jain Senior Technical Product Manager IBM App Connect Enterprise
10 MINUTE BREAK		
10:10 AM – 11:10 AM EDT	What's New in MQ ➤ New features and updates ➤ Demo	Kieran Murphy Software Developer IBM MQ, Core Software Automation
10 MINUTE BREAK		
11:20 AM – 12:20 PM EDT	DataPower/DPOD Session ➤ What's New? ➤ Deep dive into DataPower and DPOD capabilities.	Ulas Cubuk Technical Product Manager, IBM DataPower Gateway
12:20 PM – 1:05 PM	LUNCH (45 Minutes)	
1:05PM – 2:05 PM EDT	IBM MQ Troubleshooting ➤ A Practical Approach to Problem Determination	Yana Johnson Senior Software Engineer, Team Lead, IBM MQ Distributed Support
2:15 PM – 2:45 PM EDT	HashiCorp	Mehran Tamami Account Executive Majid Zarkesh Solution Engineer
15 MINUTE BREAK		
3:00 PM – 3:45 PM EDT	Open Lab Time and Q&A ➤ Labs for all products covered during the day	All IBM SMEs
3:45 PM EDT	Wrap Up	Expertise Connect) Comes to you Seminar

Agenda

Expertise Connect Comes To You Seminar

(Tuesday, October 6th, 2026)

All times USA ET

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8:00 AM -9:00 AM

Welcome,
Kickoff &
Introduction
(Your EC Team)



PANEL
DISCUSSION
(Speakers &
Panelists)

9:00 AM -10:00 AM

What's New in
ACE?



Varun Jain
Senior Technical Product
Manager, ACE

10:10 AM -11:10 AM

What's New in MQ?



Kieran Murphy
Software Developer,
IBM MQ Core Software
Automation

11:20 AM -12:20 PM

DataPower /
DPOD



Ulas Cubuk **Amit Munwes**
Product Development
Manager Lead, DPOD

12:20 PM - 1:05 PM

LUNCH

1:05 PM -2:05 PM

IBM MQ
Troubleshooting



Yana Johnson
Senior Software Engineer /
Teamlead
IBM MQ Distributed Support

2:15 PM -2:45 PM

HashiCorp



**Mehran
Tamami**
Account
Executive

**Majid
Zarkesh**
Solution
Engineer

3:00 PM -3:45 PM

Open Lab Time
and Q&A

All IBM SMEs

Agenda (Wednesday, October 7th, 2026) **All sessions given under NDA**

Time	Topic	Presenter
8:00 AM – 8:30 AM	Breakfast	
8:30 AM – 9:00 AM EDT	Panel Discussion: WAS & Liberty Open Discussion	Panelists: John Alex, Ayron Fears, Jim Clarke, Kevin Grigorenko
	10 MINUTE BREAK	
9:10 AM – 10:10 AM EDT	WebSphere Application Server & Liberty Roadmap ➤ Roadmap & New Features ➤ Library Support for Open Source	Kevin Grigorenko IBM Application Runtimes Tiger Team, IBM Software Support, Software Engineer
	10 MINUTE BREAK	
10:20 AM – 11:20 AM EDT	Java Modernization with IBM Bob and AMA Dev Tools ➤ Demo (Java Modernization using AMA & IBM Bob)	Kevin Grigorenko IBM Application Runtimes Tiger Team, IBM Software Support, Software Engineer
	10 MINUTE BREAK	
11:30 AM – 12:30 PM EDT	Benefits of Liberty over Tomcat	Kevin Grigorenko IBM Application Runtimes Tiger Team, IBM Software Support, Software Engineer
	LUNCH (1 HOUR)	
1:30 PM – 2:30 PM EDT	Update on Monitoring Metrics and Observability	Kevin Grigorenko IBM Application Runtimes Tiger Team, IBM Software Support, Software Engineer
2:30 PM – 3:00 PM EDT	Tuning Liberty for VMs and Containers	Kevin Grigorenko IBM Application Runtimes Tiger Team, IBM Software Support, Software Engineer
3:00 PM – 5:00 PM EDT	Hands-on Lab: ➤ App Modernization using AMA & AMA Dev Tools	Ayron Fears, John Alex, Kevin Grigorenko

Expertise Connect Comes To You Seminar

Wednesday, October 7, 2026

All times USA ET

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Strategies

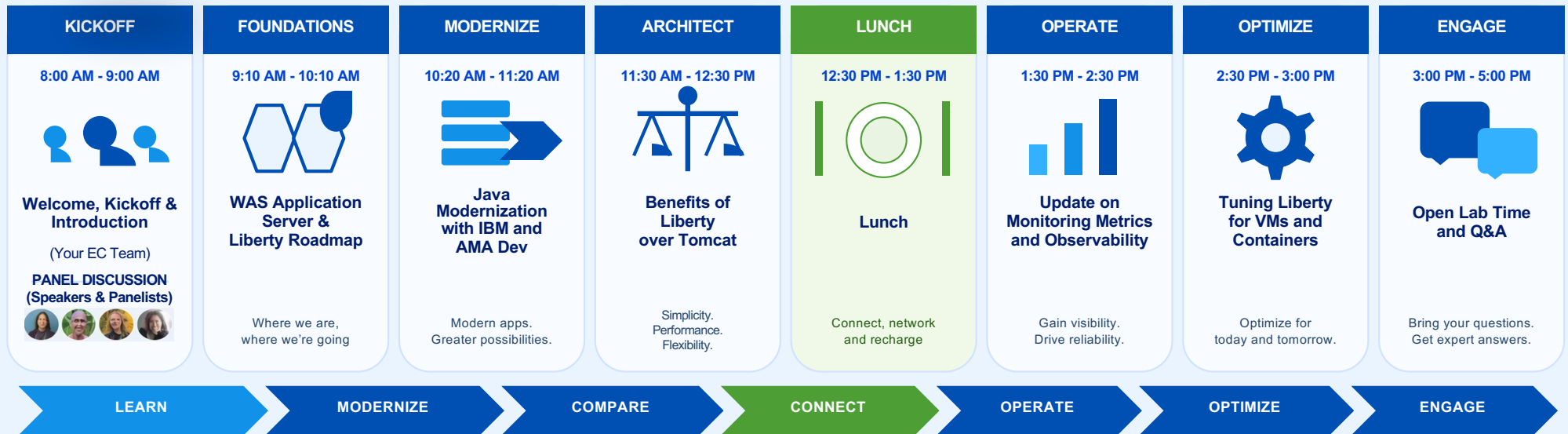


FEATURED PRESENTER

Kevin Grigorenko

IBM App Runtimes Tiger Team
IBM Software Support Engineer

*Your guide through the
Liberty Modernization Journey*



Recommended audience:

WebSphere administrators, Java architects, application developers, OpenShift engineers, and platform operations teams.

IBM

Let's create
smarter outcomes together.